

Tilly Norwood: Hollywood Hates Her [B1]

L'IA sostituirà gli umani anche nelle produzioni cinematografiche e televisive? Tilly, creata con l'intelligenza artificiale, ha acceso questo timore tra gli attori in carne ed ossa.

In a sense, Tilly Norwood is like many other aspiring actors. She is young, beautiful, and the star of a new comedy sketch that has gone viral on YouTube. She has, however, one distinctive characteristic: she isn't human. Tilly is an AI-generated character and now she is at the centre of controversy in Hollywood, where many fear AI actors will soon replace humans in the film and TV industry.

HALF A MILLION VIEWS

"You'll either get it or pretend you don't. I'm a creation." This is the tagline on Tilly Norwood's Instagram account, which has over sixty thousand followers. Of course, the tagline wasn't written by Tilly but by her creators at Xicoia. Xicoia is the AI division of the UK-based Particle6 Group, a video production service which was founded by Dutch actress, comedian, writer, and producer Eline van der Velden in 2015. Particle6 introduced Tilly to the world in 2024 through a comedy sketch titled "AI Commissioner". The sketch was written by ChatGPT and features sixteen AI-generated characters, including Tilly. In its first two months, it had almost half a million views on YouTube. Particle6 has also released videos of Tilly starring in mock film trailers, and photos of her apparently living a normal life in London, having coffee, shopping, and taking photos with her smartphone.

HOW DO YOU SAY...?

As phony as a three-dollar bill. Falso come una banconota da due euro.

NOT AN ACTOR

The controversy around Tilly is centred on the [threat](#) she represents to human actors. Particle6 has said that using Tilly (and presumably creations like her) could cut production costs by 90 per cent. Founder Eline van der Velden has said: “We want Tilly to be the next Scarlett Johansson or Natalie Portman.” Then, at the Zurich Film Festival in September, she revealed that talent agents were interested in [signing](#) Tilly. “Tilly Norwood is not an actor,” the American [union](#) SAG-AFTRA, which represents about 160,000 media professionals, including actors, said in response. “Audiences aren’t interested in watching computer-generated content [untethered](#) from the human experience.” Some Hollywood actors have [advocated](#) boycotting any talent agency that signs Tilly.

THE INEVITABILITY OF AI

However, van der Velden, an actress herself, has defended the creation, insisting that Tilly is “not a [replacement](#) for a human being, but a creative work.” And she’s implied that [regardless of](#) people’s personal feelings about AI-generated characters, [there’s no stopping](#) progress. “The age of synthetic actors isn’t coming,” she wrote on LinkedIn. “It’s here.”

Glossary

- **features** = avere come protagonista
- **threat** = minaccia
- **advocated** = sostenere
- **regardless of** = a prescindere da
- **pretend** = fingere
- **released** = pubblicare
- **mock** = falsi
- **signing** = ingaggiare
- **union** = sindacato
- **untethered** = scollegato, svincolato
- **there's no stopping** = non si può fermare
- **replace** = sostituire
- **tagline** = didascalia, slogan
- **Dutch** = olandese